SERVICE DELIVERY
THE HARYANA MODEL

Reaching the Unreached

How a citizen resource information initiative is transforming the delivery of services



The Parivar Pehchan Patra (PPP) initiative in Haryana grew out of the vision of its chief minister, Manohar Lal Khattar. Principal secretary **V. Umashankar** shares how the government has been trying out various mechanisms to put it in place from 2015.

> "The key behind Parivar Pehchan Patra is data. It essentially builds layers upon Aadhaar and retains a lot more socioeconomic data intended for the purpose of giving benefits and services to the people"
>
> **V. UMASHANKAR**
> Principal Secretary, Citizen Resource Information Department

SIGNIFICANCE OF IDENTITY

PPP essentially builds layers on Aadhaar and retains a lot more socioeconomic data intended for the purpose of giving benefits and services to the people. We have been at it for the last three years now. The normal approach of governance is that citizens apply for a particular scheme and on the basis of the application, the benefit gets processed. We have seen a few advances over the last decade. First, Aadhaar has come in as a unique identity of a person, and second, there's the direct benefit transfer mechanism. Now, it is time to progress on to the next stage, where a citizen does not need to apply for a benefit, and the system automatically recognises beneficiaries. So, it's completely inverting the citizen-government interface, where the government goes to the doorstep of the citizen instead of the citizen applying for a benefit. And at the core of that infra is PPP. For example, nobody in Haryana needs to apply for a ration card now. The system recognises beneficiaries every month, and he or she can just go to the nearest ration shop and start receiving benefits.

A REALISTIC PICTURE

Unemployment in Haryana is around 6 per cent, according to PPP data. It depends on the question that you ask because in the CMIE [Centre for Monitoring Indian Economy] survey, the question asked is not whether you are employed or not, but if you are actively looking for work. What we found is that aspirations, especially in these areas, are high. You might be engaged in something and there is a rush for, say, a government job in the north. So, when you ask a person whether they are actively looking for work, it does not mean that they are unemployed right now. It just means that they are looking for a better job. At one point, the CMIE reported an unemployment figure of 37 per cent. It doesn't seem logical.

THE RIGHT APPROACH

There have been ration cards that have been cut and there have been people who have been detected who have been taking these pensions wrongly, but the approach is not that we need to make a saving, it is, can we reach that person who is otherwise troubled? There have been a lot more additions than deletions. This programme enables the unreached to be reached, and that is the goal, that is the objective. ■